

Lesson 06

CASE STUDY: WORKPLACE COMMUNICATION**Warm-Up****Discussion:**

1. Why is effective communication crucial in the workplace?
2. Can you think of a situation where poor communication led to a problem at work?
3. How can effective communication improve teamwork and productivity?





Role-Play

Scenario: A team working under tight deadlines faces confusion about task assignments and timelines, leading to missed milestones and frustration. The project involves developing a new software application, with intense pressure to meet client expectations.

Dialogues:

John (Manager): I've noticed some confusion regarding our project deadlines. Let's clarify tasks get on the same page. We can't afford to miss any more milestones.

Alex: I wasn't aware that the deadline for my task was moved up. Can we review the timeline?

Emma: I also had some issues understanding the scope of my task. Can we discuss that as well?

John: Of course. We'll start with Alex tasks and then move on to yours, Emma. Let's address all concerns to avoid further delays.

Noah: I think it would help if we had regular check-ins to track our progress and address any issues early on.

John: Great idea, Noah. We'll schedule weekly check-ins to stay aligned and quickly tackle any problems.

Alex: Thanks for the clarification. I'll make sure to adjust my schedule to meet the new deadline.

Emma: I appreciate the discussion on the scope. I'll get started on my task right away.

Noah: Looking forward to the check-ins. I think they'll really help us stay on track.

John: Excellent. Let's maintain open communication and support each other. Our goal is to deliver a high-quality product on time.

Analysis Questions:

1. What communication issues are evident in this scenario?
2. How did the manager attempt to resolve the confusion?
3. What could the team members do to improve communication moving forward?

Discussion:

1. What are some common communication barriers in the workplace?
2. How can you ensure clear communication when assigning tasks and deadlines?
3. What strategies can be used to improve team communication?



Pronunciation

Practice pronouncing the following words.

CL arify	/ˈklærəˌfaɪ/
fru STR ation	/frʌˈstreɪʃən/
BA rrier	/ˈbæriər/
CL arity	/ˈklær.ə.ti/
esca L ation	/ˌes.kəˈleɪ.ʃən/
misinterpre T ation	/ˌmɪs.ɪnˈtɜː.prəˈteɪ.ʃən/



Production

Activity 1: Role Play: Communication at Workplace

Work in pairs or groups:

- Read the scenario and act out the role-play.
- Focus on clear communication, active listening, and professionalism.

Scenario 1: Giving Feedback

- The manager provides constructive feedback to employees.
- Employees respond and ask clarifying questions.

Scenario 2: Requesting Help

- Colleagues asked for assistance with a task.
- Another colleague provides guidance and support.

Scenario 3: Discussing Project Details

- Team members discuss project goals, timelines, and responsibilities.
- Team members clarify expectations and ask questions.

Debriefing Questions:

- What communication strategies were effective?
- What challenges arose during the role-play?
- How can these skills improve workplace interactions?

Activity 2: Group Case Study Analysis: Communication Issues

Work in pairs or small groups and follow the guidelines:

1. Case Study Analysis:

a. Analyse and identify the communication issues in the cases.

- What were the main communication issues in the case study?
- How did these issues impact the workplace environment?

b. Discuss potential solutions to address these issues.

- What strategies (active listening, clarification, etc.) can be implemented to improve communication?
- How can these strategies be applied in real-life situations?

2. Useful Phrases:

- *"It seems/looks that ..."; "The main issue/ problem was that ..."*
- *"As a result, ..."; "This affected ..."*
- *"I think the leader/the team members should ..."*
- *"It's important to ..."; "It's helpful to ..."*

3. Analysis Result: Present your findings, highlighting the communication issues and proposed solutions.

Case Study:

Case Study 1: A Cross-Department Project

EcoSolutions, a company specializing in sustainable products, is working on a major project involving both the marketing and product design teams. To prepare for a client presentation, the teams must collaborate on the branding and functionality of a new product. Nina, the marketing team leader, assumed the product design team would provide her with finalized specs for promotion materials before the meeting, whereas Alex, the design team leader, thought Nina would coordinate with his team about deadlines directly. As the presentation date approaches, certain promotional materials are unfinished, and both teams are scrambling to align their efforts.

Case Study 2: Performance Review

Jordan, the manager of a small sales team at a regional electronics supplier, holds annual performance reviews for his team to set goals for the upcoming year. During a recent review with Emily, one of the sales representatives, Jordan praised her for achieving the sales targets but suggested she "be more proactive" in managing customer relationships. Emily left the review unsure what "proactive" meant in this context—whether it required more frequent follow-ups, developing new client strategies, or taking on a larger role in sales team leadership. While Jordan assumed his suggestions were clear and actionable, Emily hesitated to ask for clarification during the meeting, fearing it might make her appear unprepared.

Debriefing Questions:

- Have you ever encountered similar communication challenges in your own experiences? If yes, how were they resolved?
- Reflect on the importance of effective communication in the workplace and how it can be improved.